

Customer Order Count

Understanding Customer Purchase Behaviour from the Online Retail Dataset

1. Task Overview

Count orders per customer and identify frequent buyers, in order to understand simple customer purchase behaviour. The analysis was carried out in Excel using the Online Retail dataset, applying formulas that recalculate automatically if the underlying data changes.

Track	Data Analytics	Tools Used	Excel, SQL
Dataset	Online Retail	Level / Day	Level 1 • Day 20

2. Methodology

A helper column flags the first line of every invoice so that multi-line orders are not double-counted. Using this flag, the following formulas were built per customer:

- **Order Count** – SUMPRODUCT of matching Customer ID and first-invoice-line flag (distinct invoices).
- **Total Quantity** – SUMIFS of quantity for each Customer ID.
- **Total Spend** – SUMPRODUCT of quantity × unit price for each Customer ID.
- **Top Customers** – RANK combined with INDEX/MATCH to extract the top 10 by order count.

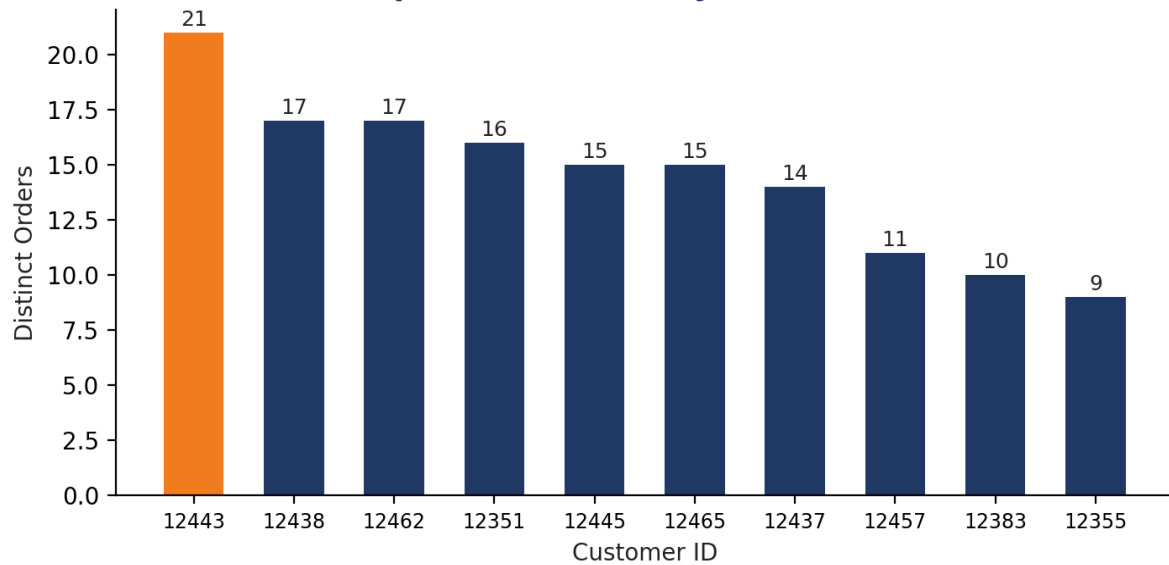
3. Key Figures

Total Order Lines	Total Customers	Total Distinct Orders	Avg. Orders / Customer
1,670	120	390	3.2

Of the 120 customers, **41** placed more than one order (repeat buyers) while **79** ordered only once. Combined customer spend across the dataset totals **£35,242.07**.

4. Top 10 Frequent Buyers

Top 10 Customers by Order Count



Rank	Customer ID	Country	Orders	Total Spend (GBP)
1	12443	Switzerland	21	1,436.16
2	12438	France	17	1,682.34
3	12462	United Kingdom	17	2,560.05
4	12351	United Kingdom	16	1,175.13
5	12445	Portugal	15	2,053.31
6	12465	Norway	15	1,488.01
7	12437	Norway	14	1,285.51
8	12457	EIRE	11	892.06
9	12383	United Kingdom	10	1,270.78
10	12355	United Kingdom	9	764.94

5. Conclusion

Using the Online Retail dataset (120 customers, 1,670 order lines), distinct orders, total quantity purchased and total spend were calculated for each customer using SUMPRODUCT, SUMIFS and INDEX/MATCH formulas, avoiding double-counting of multi-line invoices. Based on this analysis, the top 10 frequent buyers were identified using a RANK-based formula. This helps the business understand customer purchase behaviour and highlights the most valuable, repeat customers worth prioritising for retention and loyalty efforts.